DSEH004 · PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT AND EMPLOYEE ENGAGEMENT

Kahn's Three Conditions of Engagement

Week 2 · Lecture 1 · Unit II · The original theory of personal engagement and the evidence that tested it

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L1 · QUIZ 1

Quiz 1 opens now.

Phones go away once you submit. We begin the lecture when the quiz closes.

L1 · COMMIT BEFORE THEORY

An employee who works the longest hours in the team is the most engaged.

True or false? Name what hours cannot tell you.

L1 · THE ORIGINAL STUDY

Kahn (1990): engagement as presence

Method

Ethnographic study of counselors at a summer camp and members of an architecture firm, moment by moment.

Definition

Personal engagement is the harnessing of one's self to one's work role: physically, cognitively and emotionally.

Disengagement

Withdrawing and defending the self: going through the motions while absent.

Kahn, W. A. (1990). Academy of Management Journal, 33(4), 692 to 724

Each condition answers a question the person asks

CONDITION	THE PERSON'S QUESTION	WHAT SHAPES IT
Meaningfulness	Is it worth bringing myself to this?	Task characteristics, role, work interactions
Safety	Can I show myself without fear?	Relationships, group dynamics, management style, norms
Availability	Do I have the resources to bring myself?	Physical and emotional energy, insecurity, outside life

May, Gilson and Harter (2004)

Finding

All three conditions related to engagement; meaningfulness showed the strongest relationship.

What builds meaningfulness

Job enrichment and fit between the person and the role.

What builds safety

Supportive supervisors and rewarding coworker relations.

Rich, LePine and Crawford (2010)

Performance

Engagement predicted task performance and citizenship behavior.

Beyond its neighbors

It did so beyond job satisfaction, job involvement and intrinsic motivation.

Engagement is not satisfaction renamed. It is the investment of the whole self in the work.

Constructs that are often confused

CONSTRUCT	WHAT IT IS	WHY IT DIFFERS FROM ENGAGEMENT
Satisfaction	Contentment with the job	Satiation, not energy
Commitment	Attachment to the organization	Target is the firm, not the work
Workaholism	Compulsive excessive work	Driven by inner pressure, not presence
Burnout	Exhaustion and cynicism	The erosion of engagement

Macey and Schneider (2008); Schaufeli, Taris and van Rhenen (2008)

The long hours Sales employee

LENS	WHAT IT ASKS	POSSIBLE READING
Kahn	Is the self present in the role?	Present, or performing presence
Workaholism	Is the drive compulsive?	Hours reflect pressure, not energy
Burnout	Is energy being depleted?	Hours now, exit later

L1 · APPLY

Which of Kahn's three conditions is most violated in Bharat Textiles' Manufacturing, and which in Sales? What data would show it?

REFERENCES

Sources for this lecture (1 of 1)

Kahn, W. A. (1990). Psychological conditions of personal engagement and disengagement at work. Academy of Management Journal, 33(4), 692 to 724.

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